

FENWICK VALE GENERAL HOSPITAL

Medicines Information Service

FORMULARY NOTE: ACE-INHIBITOR BRAND EQUIVALENCE AND INTERACTION ALERT

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1. PURPOSE

This note addresses two unrelated prescribing risks raised with Medicines Information this quarter: brand-name allergy recording for ACE inhibitors, and a combined QT-prolongation risk between two antiarrhythmic agents.

2. ACE-INHIBITOR EQUIVALENCE

Cardaze has the same active ingredient as Zenapril. Both are ramipril preparations and differ only in presentation and manufacturer. An allergy recorded against one brand must be treated as applying to the other.

Zentanyl, despite the similar name, is an opioid analgesic and shares no active ingredient with either Cardaze or Zenapril. An intolerance to Zentanyl carries no implication for ramipril-containing products.

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3. ANTIARRHYTHMIC INTERACTION

Utrenix and Fenlorapine are contraindicated in combination. Both prolong the QT interval, and concurrent use has been associated with torsades de pointes in post-marketing reports. Prescribers should select one agent, not both.

4. FOR REFERENCE

Broxamol and Xelnorate also share an active ingredient, lisinopril, unrelated to either issue above. This is included for completeness following an unrelated query and does not concern this patient's medication.

Mr Idris Whitcombe, Lead Formulary Pharmacist